

- You *still* would have paid less in interest.
- You would have paid off almost twice as much of the principal balance.
- You'd only have five years left to go!

And these numbers only represent what's going on at the ten-year mark of these loans. If you really need more convincing that the fifteen-year mortgage is the way to go, then let's see how much money would have gone to interest over the entire course of the loans. The thirty-year mortgage would have cost you a grand total of \$161,640 in interest. That's money you basically would have given away to the bank for the pleasure of doing business with them. That's \$161,640 that you wouldn't have had going toward your net worth or into your investments. Compare that to the fifteen-year loan. With that option, you would have had to come up with \$590 more per month, but you'd be finished with the payments fifteen years sooner *and* you only would have paid \$74,520 in interest—more than \$87,000 less than the thirty-year loan would have cost you! So, just in this example, going against the flow and choosing a fifteen-year loan would have saved you more than \$87,000 and would have put you in a paid-for home in half the time. How on earth can anyone look at this and *still* choose a thirty-year mortgage? I may have answered my own question: *no one* ever looks at this. Well, no one except your average millionaire, that is.

So, if you really want to become a millionaire, then you need to start acting like one. We told you earlier that it took millionaires an average of 10.2 years to pay off their homes. How quickly could you pay off yours if you got super serious about it? What would it take? Well, I'll tell you. It would take a little planning, a big goal, and a lot of commitment over an extended period of time. So remember, at this point you're investing 15% of your income in tax-favored retirement plans and you're saving for college (if you have kids). Once you have those two things in motion, you need to look at your budget and figure out what you have left over. Any extra money you can squeeze out of your budget—and I mean everything but the kitchen sink—should go straight toward paying off your mortgage. This is not the time to take your foot off the gas. This is the very last debt standing in your way of being completely debt-free! Don't stop now. Make every penny count. Now *that's* acting like a millionaire!